

Lead sections over 300 words

Two samples per wiki: 200 **uniform-random** mainspace articles vs. each wiki's 200 **most-viewed** articles (Pageviews API, June 2026). Lead measured via the same intro extract Minerva shows collapsed. CJK wikis (ja/zh/ko) use a ~550-character proxy instead of a word count.

■ Most-read articles
 ■ Random sample

MOST-READ MEAN	RANDOM-SAMPLE MEAN	MOST-READ RANGE	RANDOM-SAMPLE RANGE
24.0%	1.8%	5–51%	0–6.6%

By wiki

Sorted by % over threshold among most-read articles, descending. Click a column header to re-sort. Both samples are 200 articles/wiki.

WIKI	% OVER — MOST-READ ▼	MEDIAN LEAD — MOST-READ	MEDIAN LEAD — I
Vietnamese vi.wikipedia.org	51.0% 1.0%	314 WORDS	24 WORDS
Spanish es.wikipedia.org	47.5% 3.5%	287 WORDS	49 WORDS
Portuguese pt.wikipedia.org	42.5% 4.0%	229 WORDS	49 WORDS
English en.wikipedia.org	37.5% 2.0%	232 WORDS	50 WORDS
Arabic ar.wikipedia.org	37.0% 0.0%	240 WORDS	31 WORDS
French fr.wikipedia.org	29.0% 0.5%	188 WORDS	37 WORDS
Persian fa.wikipedia.org	28.5% 1.5%	157 WORDS	31 WORDS
Korean ko.wikipedia.org	26.5% 6.6%	186 CHARS	150 CHARS
Czech cs.wikipedia.org	25.5%	111 WORDS	45 WORDS

WIKI	% OVER — MOST-READ ▾	MEDIAN LEAD — MOST-READ	MEDIAN LEAD — I
		0.0%	
Russian ru.wikipedia.org		25.0% 2.0% 132 WORDS	35 WORDS
Turkish tr.wikipedia.org		22.0% 0.5% 112 WORDS	24 WORDS
Italian it.wikipedia.org		20.0% 3.1% 113 WORDS	28 WORDS
Chinese zh.wikipedia.org		18.0% 2.0% 207 CHARS	107 CHARS
Indonesian id.wikipedia.org		15.5% 1.0% 105 WORDS	40 WORDS
Ukrainian uk.wikipedia.org		14.5% 1.0% 88 WORDS	32 WORDS
Polish pl.wikipedia.org		13.0% 2.6% 88 WORDS	34 WORDS
German de.wikipedia.org		9.5% 1.0% 86 WORDS	32 WORDS
Japanese ja.wikipedia.org		6.5% 2.5% 139 CHARS	115 CHARS
Hebrew he.wikipedia.org		6.5% 1.5% 53 WORDS	51 WORDS
Dutch nl.wikipedia.org		5.0% 0.5% 71 WORDS	29 WORDS

The gap is the headline. Random sampling put pagination impact at ~2% of articles — but that's dominated by short stubs, which make up most of any wiki's article count. Weighted by what people actually read, roughly **1 in 4** page views (mean 24%, up to 1-in-2 on vi/es/pt) would hit a lead section over 300 words. Reader-facing impact of this feature is much larger than raw article-count stats suggest.

Raw data: `lead_length_raw.csv` / `lead_length_top_raw.csv` · Summaries: `lead_length_summary.json` / `lead_length_top_summary.json` — all in the session scratchpad.